



# The Funniest Scientists

By Anna Kirschberg

Illustrated by James Keiaho



## Book Summary

This book looks at an entertaining story about friends, Pip and Ted, who plan to enter the school science competition. What will be their chosen topic? Detailed and vibrant illustrations depict and help the text explain some basic story information about each page.

This book follows the Beanstalk Books (Letters & Sounds) Phase 6 progression and focuses on teaching spelling patterns and affixes.

## Skills and Strategies

This book builds on decodable reading strategies. The book has been written with rich vocabulary including embedded words that contain suffixes and prefixes.

### Phase 6 - Affixes

|            |      |     |
|------------|------|-----|
| -s and -es | -ing | -ed |
| -er        | -est | un- |

Discuss the use of affixes for changing the meaning of words and the spelling rules that can be applied. The text of this book consolidates earlier taught phonics skills and revision of tricky common exception words.

#### Affixes:

-est: funniest, greatest, tastiest

Drop: funniest\*, tastiest\*

Nothing: greatest

\*Change -y to -i and add -est

### This book also supports other key reading strategies:

- Recognising the relationship between words and illustrations;
- Pointing one-to-one at each word to ensure an appropriate match;
- Vocabulary and word study.

### This book also supports key comprehension strategies:

- Predicting the meanings of new or unfamiliar words from the context of the story;
- Recognising the relationship between letters and their sounds;
- Summarising the main ideas of the story;
- Responding to simple questions about the story's content and word meanings.

## Introducing the Text

Open up the discussion about the front cover illustration and make connections with the children's prior knowledge. Prompt discussions by using the vocabulary in the book.

*What can you see on the front cover image?*

*Describe the characters in the illustration.*

*What do you predict will happen in this story, based on the title?*

Read the title and the name of the author to the group. Read aloud the examples of words with affixes added to them and any spelling rules that apply, from the front inner cover.

## **Reading the Text**

Pages 2 and 3 - As you start reading the book together, explain that this story is about Pip and Ted, who are thinking of topics for their school science fair.

Pages 4 and 5 – Here, the friends list their ideas on a notepad. What topics do they come up with?

Pages 6 and 7 – On these pages, they discuss two options for their topic. Which science idea do they decide on and why?

Page 8 – On the final page, they come up with one final idea. What topic is this and why do they think it will be funny?

Children can now read the book independently. At the end of the story, go over the text and illustrations again and discuss what is happening on each page.

## **Revisiting the Text**

As a group, begin to discuss the use of suffixes for changing the meaning of words and some of the spelling rules that may be applied. Refer back to the table in the front inner cover. For example, the word 'funny' changes to 'funniest' when the -est suffix is applied. Discuss the spelling rule used here.

Review the affix word examples on the front inner cover and discuss their meanings, and how they relate to the text.

## **Following Up**

Use the BLM for this story, the students can learn more about the use of affixes and spelling strategies.